

DAD'S CODE • BY JAMIE WIGG



Dad's Code Kitchen

Fast, fun, tasty meals a dad can make for the kids — even when Mum's working.

Present, not perfect.

15 recipes • 25 bonus ideas • all under 30 min

No chef skills required. High-protein. Kid-approved. Australian.

The kitchen's mine tonight.

When my wife works, the kitchen's mine — four kids, one tired dad, and the clock ticking toward meltdown o'clock. I'm no chef. But I've learned dinner doesn't have to be fancy — it has to be **fast, fun, and full of the good stuff** that keeps everyone (including you) going.

These are my go-to, 30-minutes-or-less, kid-approved meals. Everyday ingredients, clear numbered steps, a Dad Tip to save you, and a job for the kids on every card. Make them your own.

Present, not perfect. — Jamie

HOW TO READ A CARD

Every recipe is the same shape

So you can cook it at a glance. Every meal is ≤ 30 minutes, uses everyday ingredients, and sneaks in protein for energy.



Title badges

⚡ = extra protein. 🙌 = fun, hands-on for the kids.



Meta row

Time to table, how many it serves, and a rough protein-per-serve badge.



Ingredients & steps

Ingredients on the left, numbered steps on the right. Stacks on your phone.



Dad Tip

The shortcut or save that turns "meltdown o'clock" into a win.



Kid Job

How the kids help — because it's more fun (and less work) with hands on deck.

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What's for dinner?

Four sections, fifteen full recipes, twenty-five bonus ideas. Tap any meal to jump straight to it.

15-Min Heroes

The fastest wins on the board.

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| 1 | Scrambled Egg & Ham Wraps | ⚡ 🙌 | 2 | Cheesy Tuna Melt Boats | ⚡ |
| 3 | Chicken & Cheese Quesadilla Triangles | ⚡ 🙌 | 4 | Crunchy Fish Finger Wraps | ⚡ |

Family Favourites

The dinner-table staples.

- | | | | | | |
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Fun Hands-On

Kids do the work.

- | | | | | | |
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Crispy Chickpea & Cheese Nachos



Sweet Treats

The happy ending.

15

Peanut Butter Banana "Sushi"



+

25 More 30-Minute Ideas



✂ 15-MIN HEROES

Fastest wins on the board

When the clock's already against you, start here. In and out in fifteen minutes flat.

⚡ 15-MIN HEROES • RECIPE 01

01 Scrambled Egg & Ham Wraps

⚡ PROTEIN

👨‍🍳 KIDS

⌚ TIME
10 min

👤 SERVES
4

💪 PROTEIN
~18g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 8 eggs
- Splash of milk
- 4 slices ham, chopped
- Grated cheese
- 4 tortillas
- Butter, salt

STEPS

- 1 Whisk eggs with milk and a pinch of salt.
- 2 Soft-scramble in a buttered pan over low heat.
- 3 Stir ham and cheese through at the end.
- 4 Spoon into tortillas, roll, and serve.



DAD TIP

Low and slow = soft eggs. Pull them off the heat while still glossy.



KID JOB

Whisking the eggs and rolling the wraps.

⚡ 15-MIN HEROES • RECIPE 02

02 Cheesy Tuna Melt Boats

⚡ PROTEIN

⌚ TIME
15 min

👤 SERVES
4

💪 PROTEIN
~22g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 2 tins tuna, drained
- 2 tbsp mayo
- ½ cup corn
- 4 bread rolls, halved
- Grated cheese

STEPS

- 1 Mix tuna, mayo and corn.
- 2 Hollow the rolls slightly and pile the mix in.
- 3 Top with cheese.
- 4 Grill 3-4 min until bubbling and golden.



DAD TIP

Cheap, fast, big protein hit — keep tinned tuna in the cupboard for emergencies.



KID JOB

Filling the boats with the tuna mix.

⚡ 15-MIN HEROES • RECIPE 03

03 Chicken & Cheese Quesadilla Triangles

⚡ PROTEIN

👨‍🍳 KIDS

⌚ TIME
15 min

👤 SERVES
4

💪 PROTEIN
~24g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 2 cups cooked chicken, shredded
- Grated cheese
- 8 tortillas
- Salsa or sour cream, to serve

STEPS

- 1 Layer chicken and cheese between two tortillas.
- 2 Pan-fry both sides until golden and the cheese melts.
- 3 Cut into triangles.
- 4 Serve with salsa or sour cream for dunking.



DAD TIP

Use leftover roast chook or a supermarket BBQ chicken to skip the cooking.



KID JOB

⚡ 15-MIN HEROES • RECIPE 04

04 Crunchy Fish Finger Wraps

⚡ PROTEIN

⌚ TIME
15 min

👤 SERVES
4

💪 PROTEIN
~16g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 12 oven fish fingers
- 4 wraps
- Shredded lettuce
- Grated cheese
- Mayo

STEPS

- 1 Bake fish fingers per packet.
- 2 Smear mayo on each wrap.
- 3 Add lettuce, cheese and 3 fish fingers.
- 4 Roll up and serve handheld.



DAD TIP

Handheld = happy kids and almost no plates to wash.



KID JOB

Building and rolling their own wrap.

The dinner-table staples

The meals everyone asks for again. Hearty, protein-packed, still under thirty.

05 **Build-Your-Own Taco Night**

 **PROTEIN**

 **KIDS**

 **TIME**
20 min

 **SERVES**
4-5

 **PROTEIN**
~26g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 500g beef mince
- 1 sachet taco seasoning
- Taco shells
- Grated cheese, lettuce, tomato, corn

STEPS

- 1 Brown the mince, breaking it up as it cooks.
- 2 Stir in taco seasoning and a splash of water; simmer 3 min.
- 3 Lay out shells and toppings on the table.
- 4 Everyone builds their own.

**DAD TIP**

Lean into the chaos — letting them build it is half the fun.

**KID JOB**

Assembling tacos and laying out the topping bowls.

06 Speedy Spag Bol

 **PROTEIN**

 **TIME**
30 min

 **SERVES**
4-6

 **PROTEIN**
~25g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 500g beef mince
- 1 jar pasta sauce
- 1 carrot + 1 zucchini, grated
- 400g spaghetti
- Grated cheese, to serve

STEPS

- 1 Brown the mince.
- 2 Stir in the grated veg and the jar sauce; simmer 15 min.
- 3 Cook spaghetti until al dente.
- 4 Combine and top with cheese.



DAD TIP

Make a double batch — it freezes brilliantly for next week's solo night.



KID JOB

Grating the hidden veg (carrot and zucchini).

07 Sheet-Pan Sausages & Veg

 **TIME**
30 min

 **SERVES**
4

 **PROTEIN**
~20g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 8 sausages
- 3 potatoes, chopped
- 1 capsicum, chopped
- 1 onion, wedged
- Olive oil, salt

STEPS

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C.
- 2 Toss everything on one tray with oil and salt.
- 3 Bake 25 min, turning once.
- 4 Serve straight from the tray.



DAD TIP

One tray, almost no washing up. Line it with baking paper.



KID JOB

Tossing the veg in oil before it goes in.

08 Honey Soy Drumsticks **PROTEIN**

 **TIME**
30 min

 **SERVES**
4

 **PROTEIN**
~28g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 12 chicken drumsticks
- 3 tbsp honey
- 3 tbsp soy sauce
- 2 cloves garlic, crushed

STEPS

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C.
- 2 Toss drumsticks in honey, soy and garlic.
- 3 Spread on a lined tray.
- 4 Bake 25 min until sticky and cooked through.

**DAD TIP**

Spoon the tray juices back over halfway for extra sticky glaze.

**KID JOB**

Mixing the marinade and tossing the drumsticks (then washing hands!).

09 Loaded Sweet Potato Boats **PROTEIN**

 **TIME**
30 min

 **SERVES**
4

 **PROTEIN**
~24g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 4 sweet potatoes
- 400g beef mince, seasoned
- Grated cheese

STEPS

- 1 Microwave sweet potatoes 8 min until soft.
- 2 Brown and season the mince.
- 3 Split potatoes, top with mince and cheese.
- 4 Grill 3 min until cheese melts.



DAD TIP

Microwave first, oven last — that's how you beat the 30-minute clock.



KID JOB

Sprinkling cheese on top of the boats.

 **FUN HANDS-ON**

Kids do the work

Crumbing, rolling, scattering, designing. The more hands on deck, the less it feels like a chore.

10 Loaded Baked Chicken Nuggets

⚡ PROTEIN

👏 KIDS

🕒 TIME
25 min

👤 SERVES
4

💪 PROTEIN
~30g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 600g chicken breast, cut into bites
- 2 eggs, beaten
- 2 cups cornflakes, crushed
- ½ cup parmesan
- Oven chips + carrot sticks, to serve

STEPS

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C.
- 2 Dip chicken in egg, then in cornflake-parmesan crumb.
- 3 Spread on a lined tray.
- 4 Bake 18 min until golden and cooked through.



DAD TIP

Set up an egg bowl and a crumb bowl — assembly-line crumbing keeps the mess in one place.



KID JOB

Crushing the cornflakes and crumbing the chicken.

11 Mini Meatball Subs

⚡ PROTEIN

👏 KIDS

🕒 TIME
30 min

👤 SERVES
4

💪 PROTEIN
~27g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 500g beef/pork mince
- 1 jar pasta sauce
- 4 small bread rolls
- Grated cheese

STEPS

- 1 Roll mince into mini meatballs.
- 2 Pan-fry until browned.
- 3 Simmer in pasta sauce 10 min.
- 4 Tuck into rolls and top with cheese.

**DAD TIP**

Wet your hands before rolling so the mince doesn't stick.

**KID JOB**

Rolling the meatballs.

12 DIY Pizza Pitas

👏 KIDS

⌚ TIME
20 min

👤 SERVES
4

💪 PROTEIN
~14g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 4 pita breads
- Pizza/pasta sauce
- Grated cheese
- Toppings of their choice

STEPS

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C.
- 2 Spread sauce on each pita.
- 3 Add cheese and chosen toppings.
- 4 Bake 10 min until crisp.

**DAD TIP**

Add a few slices of ham or leftover chicken for a bigger protein hit.

**KID JOB**

Designing their own face or animal pizza.

13 Rainbow Egg Muffins

⚡ PROTEIN

🕒 TIME
25 min • make-ahead

👤 SERVES
4 (12 muffins)

💪 PROTEIN
~16g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 8 eggs
- 1 capsicum, chopped
- 4 slices ham, chopped
- ½ cup peas
- Grated cheese

STEPS

- 1 Heat oven to 180°C; grease a muffin tin.
- 2 Whisk eggs, stir in capsicum, ham, peas and cheese.
- 3 Pour into tin cups.
- 4 Bake 18 min until set.



DAD TIP

Great hot or cold — make a batch for breakfast-for-dinner or lunchboxes.



KID JOB

Choosing and stirring in the "rainbow" fillings.

14 Crispy Chickpea & Cheese Nachos

⚡ PROTEIN

⌚ TIME
20 min

👤 SERVES
4

💪 PROTEIN
~15g / serve



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 1 large bag corn chips
- 1 tin chickpeas, drained
- Grated cheese
- Salsa, to serve

STEPS

- 1 Heat oven to 200°C.
- 2 Roast chickpeas 10 min until crisp.
- 3 Spread corn chips on a tray, scatter chickpeas and cheese.
- 4 Grill until melted; top with salsa.



DAD TIP

Veggie protein and big crunch — pat the chickpeas dry before roasting for max crispness.



KID JOB

The happy ending

A five-minute win to finish the night — or an after-school treat.

15 Peanut Butter Banana "Sushi"

 **KIDS**

 **TIME**
5 min

 **SERVES**
4

 **PROTEIN**
Treat



PHOTO SLOT

INGREDIENTS

- 4 tortillas
- Peanut butter
- 4 bananas

STEPS

- 1 Spread peanut butter on each tortilla.
- 2 Place a peeled banana at one edge.
- 3 Roll up tightly.
- 4 Slice into bite-size "sushi" rounds.



DAD TIP

Five-minute treat or after-school win.



KID JOB

Spreading, rolling and slicing (kid-safe knife).



NUT ALLERGY

Swap peanut butter for cream cheese.

BONUS

25 more 30-minute ideas

Quick fire-up ideas for the nights you've run out of brain. Same rules — fast, everyday ingredients, protein where you can.

- 01 Toasted ham & cheese jaffles
- 02 Chicken fried rice
- 03 Pesto pasta + peas
- 04 Bean quesadillas
- 05 Sausage rolls (puff pastry)
- 06 Egg-fried noodles
- 07 Burrito bowls
- 08 Mini beef burgers
- 09 Baked beans on toast w/ cheese
- 10 Chicken caesar wraps
- 11 Veggie frittata
- 12 Pasta bake
- 13 Loaded potato wedges
- 14 BBQ chicken pizza
- 15 Fish tacos
- 16 Pumpkin soup + cheese toasties
- 17 Teriyaki chicken bowls
- 18 Ham & pineapple muffins
- 19 Mac & cheese (+ hidden veg)
- 20 Breakfast burritos
- 21 Meat & cheese "lunchables" dinner plate
- 22 Chicken noodle soup
- 23 Savoury mince on toast
- 24 Veggie-loaded omelette
- 25 Pita & dip platter with boiled eggs

THE CLOSE

Feed them well. Laugh at the mess.

You don't need to be a chef. You need 30 minutes and the will to show up at the stove. Cook one of these tonight, let the kids wreck the kitchen a little, and call it a win.

If a recipe lands, that's the whole point — you were **present**, and dinner got done. That's the same idea the whole podcast is built on.



Listen to the podcast

Real talk on showing up for your kids



Get *Dad Fuel*

The companion guide to feeding yourself, too

Present, not perfect. — Jamie

⚠ SAFETY & ALLERGY DISCLAIMER

This book is general info, not nutrition advice. Always check ingredient labels for allergens (nuts, dairy, gluten, egg, soy) and adjust for your family. Always supervise children around heat, sharp tools and the stove. Ensure all meat, chicken, fish and eggs are cooked through before serving.

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